



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

adhastān na-upadadhyāc ca na ca-enam abhilaṅghayet | 4.54a
na ca-enam pādataḥ kuryān na prāṇa.ābādham ācaret || 54 || 4.54c
na-aśnīyāt sandhivelāyām na gacchen na-api saṃviśet | 4.55a
na ca-eva pralikhed bhūmiṃ na-ātmano 'paharet srajam || 55 || 4.55c

— Manusmṛti, 4.1.9. Rules of Conduct-II (Chapter 9), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

These verses from the Manusmṛti offer guidance on maintaining reverence and avoiding actions that disrupt inner peace and harmony with the world around you. The instruction not to place anything below a sacred object or step over it emphasizes respect for symbols and things held as spiritually significant. Think of it as honoring the energy and intention invested in these objects, preventing their devaluation in your mind and the minds of others. Similarly, not touching them with your feet reinforces this sacred boundary, keeping your physical actions aligned with your respect. Avoiding actions that cause distress to living beings underscores the principle of ahimsa, non-violence, extending beyond physical harm to encompass emotional and spiritual well-being.

The verses then shift to actions to avoid during twilight, the meeting point of day and night. This is considered a liminal time, a period of heightened spiritual sensitivity when the veil between worlds is thin. Abstaining from eating, traveling, or sleeping during this time encourages you to be present and receptive, allowing for introspection and connection with the divine. The injunction against scratching the earth or removing flowers from oneself speaks to mindful interaction with the environment and a sense of contentment. Scratching the earth can be seen as a restless act, while removing one's garland suggests discontentment with what you have.

In modern life, these principles translate into cultivating mindfulness in your daily actions. Consider the objects you cherish and treat them with respect. Be mindful of your impact on the environment, choosing sustainable practices and appreciating the beauty around you. Embrace the quiet moments, especially during transitional times like sunrise and sunset, for reflection and gratitude. These verses remind you that even seemingly small actions can have a profound impact on your inner state and your connection to the world. By living with awareness and reverence, you cultivate a more harmonious and fulfilling life.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you incorporate these principles of reverence and mindfulness into your daily routine to cultivate a deeper sense of inner peace and connection?